



CVR - 42651664

## **INTERNATIONAL DIPLOMATIC COUNCIL OF TAMIL EELAM**

Østerbrogade 226, st. 1.,  
2100 København Ø, Denmark

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE  
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### **16th Tamil Genocide Remembrance Day**

Today, we join with Eelam Tamils around the globe in marking the 16th Tamil Genocide Remembrance Day.

Sixteen years have passed since the brutal Mullivaikkal genocide against Eelam Tamils, yet justice and accountability remain long overdue. Tamils continue to live under the shadow of one of the 21st century's most horrific atrocities, without acknowledgment, accountability, or justice. The international community's ongoing failure to pursue accountability is not only a betrayal of the victims, but an encouragement for continued impunity.

In May 2009, during the final phase of the war, the state perpetrated a genocide against the Tamil population trapped in the Vanni region in the so called "No Fire Zone". Mullivaikkal, in particular, became a killing field—where over 169 796 Tamils were killed according to World Bank data and tens of thousands forcibly disappeared. The Sri Lankan state used banned weapons including white phosphorus and cluster munitions, targeted hospitals and designated No Fire Zones, and denied international humanitarian aid. Women, children, and the elderly were not spared. Those who surrendered were often tortured, executed, or disappeared.

The new JVP/NPP government of Anura Kumara Disanayake, which presented itself as a break from corrupt and violent regimes of the past, has proven to be no beacon of hope for the Tamil people. The Sinhala ethnocentric state, with its constitution giving the foremost importance to Buddhism, perpetuates an establishment that oppresses Eelam Tamils rights and voices. As long as the Sinhala ethnocentric state's Sinhala chauvinism establishment remains, no newly elected administration can address the national question of Eelam Tamils. Without reforming these entrenched Sinhalese ethnocentric structures, changes in leadership are inconsequential, bringing no real progress for the Eelam Tamils demands.

We at the IDCTE, powerfully reaffirm our unwavering commitment to tirelessly advocate justice, accountability, and recognition of Tamil Genocide and establishment of a sovereign and free Tamileelam based on our rights to self-determination with policy makers worldwide throughout our engagement. The heroic sacrifices of our martyrs and the enduring courage of survivors continue to fuel our unyielding commitment for our struggle.

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